

Shinya Mori – CV

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Profile

Shinya Mori is an artist and researcher exploring the co-existence of multiple realities through the intersection of technology, society, and art. He serves as the Director of "**Yu Tokiwa**," imi Inc.'s collective artist identity.

Since 2022, his primary research focus has been the sustainability of digital public goods. He specializes in the research, design, and social implementation of decentralized grants mechanisms that support open-source communities. He has presented his research at premier global venues, including the Ethereum Foundation's **Devcon SEA**, actively contributing to the international Ethereum-centric public goods ecosystem. As the co-organizer of "Funding the Commons Tokyo", he designed the event concepts, structured academic agendas, and secured global partnerships, building a collaborative platform for experts across industry, government, and academia.

In December 2023, he co-founded **imi Inc.** and established the artist group "**Yu Tokiwa**" to lead art direction and concept formulation with a focus on socio-technological implications. By bridging academic research, community-engaged social practice, and artistic creation, he explores new spatial, systemic, and relational models where diverse narratives can coexist.

Education

Master's Program in Physics (Withdrew)

Graduate School of Science and Technology, Tokyo University of Science, Japan | 2022

Bachelor of Science in Physics

Tokyo University of Science, Japan | 2020

High School Diploma

Sendai Ikuei Gakuen High School, Japan | 2015

Research & Professional Experience

Co-founder / Artist — imi Inc.

Tokyo, Japan | Dec 2023–Present

- **Role & Mission:** Directing artistic practices addressing the socio-technological implications of blockchain and AI. Designing systems that connect cultural arts with industrial, educational, and public sectors to foster environments where multiple values and narratives can coexist. Overseeing artistic creation as the Director of the collective artist group "Yu Tokiwa".

- **Main Approach:**

- **General Incorporated Association Beacon Labs (2024–2026):** Engaged in the launch and research design of Beacon Labs as a core activity of imi Inc. Led research themes on crypto-native funding models and presented findings at top-tier international conferences, including the Ethereum Foundation's Devcon SEA and Funding the Commons.
- **Social Impact Evaluation OSS "MUSE" (2025):** Co-developed by imi Inc. under R&D Contract with General Incorporated Association Beacon Labs. Designed technical specifications and conceptualized an open-source protocol to visualize and evaluate public goods impact based on empirical evidence.
- **Resilience Experimental Residency "kuu village" (2025–Present):** Co-organized a one-week communal living residency testing decentralized and off-grid networks across digital (self-hosted local servers, onchain coordination protocol) and physical (DIY shelters, water wells) domains.
- **Nishiawakura Village Natural Capital App (2026–Present):** Supervised token economics design and business development in a joint project with Nishiawakura Municipality (a local government renowned for progressive environmental forestry models) and Code for Japan. Designed on-chain systems to connect environmental conservation with economic incentives.

- **Core Art & Management Initiatives:**

- Directing artwork production, curation, and creative strategy under the collective name "Yu Tokiwa".
- Conceptualizing and executing community-led urban regeneration projects and public-private contemporary art festivals.
- Organizing multidisciplinary symposia bridging technology, philosophy, and creativity. Conceived and directed the 10th-anniversary commemorative conference for legendary environmental economist Hirofumi Uzawa, reinterpreting his "Social Common Capital" framework within modern internet/Web3 contexts.

Incubator — Fracton Ventures

Tokyo, Japan | 2022–2024

- **Role & Mission:** Managed program roadmaps, timeline execution, and cohort support as a Program Manager for a Web3 / DAO-focused startup incubation program.
- **Core Initiatives:**
 - Provided strategic 1-on-1 mentoring and lectures to Web3 protocol developers on decentralized governance, community building, and business model design.
 - Formulated tailored acceleration roadmaps and milestone tracking for participating cohorts.
 - Produced and coordinated Demo Days, showcasing project outputs to international venture capital partners, ecosystems, and investors.
 - Planned and co-organized "DAO TOKYO", a flagship international DAO conference expanding public discourse around decentralized coordination.
 - Participated as an active researcher in the Grants Innovation Lab (convened by Metagov) and served as a council member for the Polygon Community Grants.

Video Media Founding Editor-in-Chief (Director) — CoinPost

Tokyo, Japan | 2021–2022

- **Role & Mission:** Directed video media strategies and programming focusing on decentralized technologies and blockchain ecosystems.

- **Core Initiatives:**

- Co-founded "CONNECTV" (currently WebX Studio), a joint video media venture with major publisher Gentosha. Managed programming concepts, content direction, video production, and audience scale as the founding Editor-in-Chief (Director).

Selected Research Projects & Systems

MUSE (Impact Evaluation System) | 2025 [Co-developed by imi Inc. under R&D Contract with General Incorporated Association Beacon Labs]

- **Overview:** An open-source protocol and framework evaluating qualitative social impact through evidence-based practice (EBP) in digital public goods, science, and arts. MUSE utilizes AI to construct logic models (causal pathways of impact) and dynamically anchors them to empirical research evidence.
- **Role:** Co-initiator, concept formulator, specification architect, and R&D protocol lead.

Experimental Village "kuu village" | 2025–Present [Implemented by imi Inc.]

- **Overview:** A one-week resilience residency testing off-grid living across digital (self-hosted servers, onchain coordination protocol) and physical (DIY shelters, water wells, mutual support) domains to foster autonomous local community networks.
- **Role:** Co-initiator & R&D experiment producer.

Nishiawakura Village Natural Capital App | 2026–Present [Implemented by imi Inc.]

- **Overview:** A mobile app and on-chain ecosystem designed in collaboration with Nishiawakura Village (Okayama Prefecture), Nishiawakura the Village-Wide Research Institute, and Code for Japan. It maps regional forest conservation and biodiversity initiatives to on-chain carbon credits, distributing tokenized incentives to contributors.
- **Role:** Token economics architect, business developer, and marketing lead.

"Funding the Commons Tokyo" Symposium | 2024

- **Overview:** Japan's inaugural academic symposium addressing sustainable funding mechanisms for public goods, integrating Web3, cryptography, and alternative economics.
- **Role:** Co-organizer. Contributed to concept design, curated academic agendas, and secured global partnerships with prominent international researchers.

Selected Artistic Practices & Exhibitions

Artistic Works under collective identity "Yu Tokiwa" [Implemented by imi Inc.]

- **Lights | 2025 (Sumida Mukojima EXPO 6)**
 - *Medium:* Mist, light bulb, glass, 2025.
 - *Concept:* An installation featuring a glass and a bulb salvaged from the venue house—representing past community life—juxtaposed with dynamically shifting mist generating fleeting, subjective rainbows. It invites viewers to imagine "invisible rainbows" that fall outside standard human sensory perception.

- **Flowers | 2024 (Sumida Mukojima EXPO 2024)**
 - *Medium:* Text, NFT, cube signage, natural sounds, floral scents, 2024.
 - *Concept:* An interactive installation using text-only NFTs (built on the open-source "Loot" protocol) mapped to native flora of Kyojima (a historic pre-war neighborhood in Tokyo). Projected on cube screens with olfactory and ambient soundscapes, it triggers unique, subjective floral landscapes inside the viewers' minds.
- **Epistemology in AI | 2024 (Winner of "We Love the Art" AI Art Category)**
 - *Medium:* AI-generated digital painting, 2024.
 - *Concept:* A generative digital artwork exploring AI's "Umwelt" (subjective world). By inputting non-intentional human sketches and instructing the AI to interpret and render, the work reveals the AI's internal processing bias and autonomous visual grammar.

Awards / Honors

- **2024** – AI Art Category Winner, "We Love the Art" Digital Art Contest [Awarded under "Yu Tokiwa"]

Exhibitions & Production Projects

Hirofumi Uzawa 10th Anniversary Conference "Social Common Capital" | Sep 27, 2024 [Implemented by imi Inc.]

- **Overview:** A major commemorative forum held at the United Nations University (UNU) celebrating economist Hirofumi Uzawa (one of Japan's most prominent environmental economists, known as a leading candidate for the Nobel Prize in Economics). Focused on re-contextualizing his environmental and social framework "Social Common Capital" through the lens of modern internet, open-source software, and Web3. Attracted ~400 participants.
- **Role:** Co-conceived and executed as Lead Producer / Project Manager / Creative Director / PR Director in partnership with Uzawa Memorial House.

"PLURALITY BOOK" Japan Release Launch | May 2025 [Implemented by imi Inc.]

- **Overview:** Official translation release event for the book "PLURALITY" at Roppongi Tsutaya Books, hosting authors Audrey Tang and E. Glen Weyl with moderator Ryuichiro Takeshita.
- **Role:** Organizer, booking agent, production lead, and program manager.

Japan Metaverse Awards 2024 | 2024 [Implemented by imi Inc.]

- **Overview:** First cultural and technological awards ceremony held at Muromachi Mitsui Hall, receiving 142 submissions and hosting 500+ attendees. Judged by distinguished panels.
- **Role:** Project planner, and event lead.

Conference Presentations

- **2026** – Yamanashi Prefectural University, Makers Engineering Department Guest Lecture [Implemented by imi Inc.]
- **2025** – *Funding the Commons Buenos Aires* [Implemented by General Incorporated Association Beacon Labs]
- **2024** – *Devcon SEA (hosted by Ethereum Foundation)*, Bangkok [Implemented by General Incorporated Association Beacon Labs]
- **2024** – *Funding the Commons Bangkok* [Implemented by General Incorporated Association Beacon Labs]

- **2023** – *Funding the Commons Taipei* [Implemented by General Incorporated Association Beacon Labs]
- **2023** – *Funding the Commons Berlin* [Implemented by Fracton Ventures]
- **2023** – *Ethcon Korea* [Implemented by Fracton Ventures]

Publications

- **2025** – "Evidence Layer for Digital Public Goods", Beacon Labs
- **2025** – "Plurality and Ethereum", Shinya Mori
- **2024** – "Instrumentalized Plurality: Dialectic of Enlightenment Fixes Plurality", Beacon Labs
- **2024** – "The Bridge between Crypto and Economics: Funding the Commons Tokyo Report", Shinya Mori
- **2024** – "A Retrospective Quantitative Review of Crypto Grants Programs", Beacon Labs
- **2024** – "Introduction to Quadratic Funding (QF)", Shinya Mori
- **2024** – "Positive-sum Design with Crypto", Beacon Labs